

G4-P01

Bonus Included

COLOR PALETTES THAT ACTUALLY MATCH

Choose the right yarn without guessing



Color Guide for Crochet



Crochet for Your Home

Table of Contents

1 • Essential Crochet Stitches	3
2 • Reading Patterns	7
3 • Yarn Guide	9
4 • Essential Tools	11
5 • Finishing Techniques	13
6 • Troubleshooting	15
Next Step	17

SECTION 1

Essential Crochet Stitches

Your complete reference for every stitch used in the 30 patterns included in this collection.

Each stitch below includes its standard abbreviation, symbol, description, and the best situations to use it. Bookmark this section — you will come back to it often.

Foundation & Basic Stitches

STITCH	ABBR.	SYMBOL	HOW TO WORK IT	BEST FOR
Chain	ch	○	Yarn over, pull through the loop on the hook.	Foundation rows, turning chains, spacing
Slip Stitch	sl st	•	Insert hook, yarn over, pull through both the stitch and the loop on the hook in one motion.	Joining rounds, invisible seaming, surface decoration
Single Crochet	sc	+	Insert hook, yarn over and pull up a loop (2 loops on hook), yarn over and pull through both loops.	Dense fabric, amigurumi, coasters, tight edges
Half Double Crochet	hdc	T	Yarn over, insert hook, yarn over and pull up a loop (3 loops on hook), yarn over and pull through all 3 loops.	Slightly taller than sc, good drape, blanket borders
Double Crochet	dc	†	Yarn over, insert hook, yarn over and pull up a loop (3 loops), yarn over and pull through 2 loops, yarn over and pull through remaining 2 loops.	Most common stitch for blankets, cushions, table runners
Treble Crochet	tr	‡	Yarn over twice, insert hook, yarn over and pull up a loop (4 loops), then work off 2 loops at a time (3 yarn overs total).	Lacy patterns, openwork, tall stitches
Double Treble Crochet	dtr	‡‡	Yarn over three times, insert hook, yarn over and pull up a loop (5 loops), then work off 2 loops at a time (4 yarn overs total).	Very open, lacy designs, decorative crosses

Post Stitches

STITCH	ABBR.	HOW TO WORK IT	BEST FOR
Front Post Double Crochet	FPdc	Yarn over, insert hook from front to back around the post of the stitch below, yarn over and pull up a loop, complete as a regular dc.	Ribbing, cable patterns, textured blankets
Back Post Double Crochet	BPdc	Yarn over, insert hook from back to front around the post of the stitch below, yarn over and pull up a loop, complete as a regular dc.	Ribbing (pairs with FPdc), basket weave pattern
Front Post Single Crochet	FPsc	Insert hook from front to back around the post of the stitch below, yarn over and pull up a loop, yarn over and pull through both loops.	Subtle texture, edgings, low-profile ribbing
Back Post Single Crochet	BPsc	Insert hook from back to front around the post of the stitch below, yarn over and pull up a loop, yarn over and pull through both loops.	Reverse texture, pairs with FPsc for ribbing

Textured & Decorative Stitches

STITCH	ABBR.	HOW TO WORK IT	BEST FOR
Popcorn	pop	Work 5 dc in the same stitch, remove hook from loop, insert hook in the first dc of the group, pick up the dropped loop and pull through. Chain 1 to lock.	Bold 3D texture, cushion fronts, statement blankets
Bobble	bo	Work 5 dc in the same stitch, but stop each dc with 2 loops remaining (6 loops on hook). Yarn over and pull through all 6 loops at once.	Raised dots, polka-dot patterns, cozy textures
Puff Stitch	puff	[Yarn over, insert hook, pull up a loop] 3–5 times in the same stitch (7–11 loops on hook). Yarn over and pull through all loops. Chain 1 to close.	Soft, puffy texture, baby blankets, cushions
Shell	sh	Work multiple stitches (typically 5 dc) into the same stitch or space. The fan shape forms naturally.	Elegant borders, blanket patterns, table runners
V-Stitch	V-st	Work (1 dc, ch 1, 1 dc) all in the same stitch or space.	Light, airy fabric, spring/summer blankets, placemats
Cluster	cl	Work 3–5 dc across several stitches, leaving the last loop of each dc on the hook (4–6 loops), then yarn over and pull through all loops.	Shaping, lace patterns, decorative edgings

STITCH	ABBR.	HOW TO WORK IT	BEST FOR
Picot	picot	Chain 3, slip stitch into the first chain.	Decorative edging, delicate borders, doilies

Techniques & Decrease Stitches

STITCH / TECHNIQUE	ABBR.	HOW TO WORK IT	BEST FOR
Magic Ring	MR	Wrap yarn around fingers to form a loop. Insert hook through the loop, yarn over and pull up a loop. Chain 1. Work the required number of stitches into the ring. Pull the tail to close the center hole tightly.	Starting circles, coasters, round cushions, mandalas
Single Crochet 2 Together	sc2tog	Insert hook in next stitch, pull up a loop. Insert hook in the following stitch, pull up a loop (3 loops). Yarn over and pull through all 3 loops.	Decreasing, shaping curves, tapered edges
Double Crochet 2 Together	dc2tog	Yarn over, insert hook in next stitch, pull up a loop, yarn over and pull through 2 loops (2 loops remain). Repeat in the next stitch (3 loops remain). Yarn over and pull through all 3.	Decreasing in taller stitches, chevron patterns
Foundation Single Crochet	fsc	Chain 2. Insert hook in the first ch, pull up a loop (2 loops). Yarn over and pull through 1 loop (the chain). Yarn over and pull through both loops (the sc). For each subsequent stitch, insert hook under 2 loops of the chain just made.	Flexible foundation row, blankets, garments

Quick Reference Tip

When working a pattern from this collection, keep this section open beside you. Most patterns use only 5–8 of these stitches — check the pattern header for the specific stitches required before you start.

SECTION 2

Reading Patterns

How to decode any written crochet pattern with confidence.

Written patterns can look like a foreign language the first time. Once you learn the shorthand, you will read them as easily as a recipe.

Standard Abbreviations

ch — chain	tog — together
sl st — slip stitch	RS — right side
sc — single crochet	WS — wrong side
hdc — half double crochet	BL — back loop
dc — double crochet	FL — front loop
tr — treble crochet	beg — beginning
dtr — double treble crochet	inc — increase
sk — skip	dec — decrease
sp — space	pm — place marker
st(s) — stitch(es)	FO — fasten off
yo — yarn over	MC — main color
rep — repeat	CC — contrasting color

Understanding Pattern Notation

SYMBOL	MEANING	EXAMPLE
* ... *	Repeat everything between the asterisks the number of times stated.	*sc in next 3 sts, 2 sc in next st* repeat 6 times = work the sequence 6 times total
[...]	Repeat the group inside brackets. Often interchangeable with asterisks.	[dc, ch 1, dc] in same sp = a V-stitch worked into one space
(...)	Stitches worked into the same stitch or space, OR clarifying information.	(2 dc, ch 2, 2 dc) in corner sp = all 6 elements go into the one corner space
(N) at end	Total stitch count for that row or round.	Row 5: sc in each st across (48) = you should have 48 stitches when finished

Gauge — Why It Matters

Gauge tells you how many stitches and rows fit in a 10 cm (4") square using the recommended yarn and hook. If your gauge is off:

- **Too many stitches** in 10 cm → your tension is tight → go up one hook size
- **Too few stitches** in 10 cm → your tension is loose → go down one hook size

For home decor items like cushion covers and placemats, gauge matters more than for blankets because they need to fit a specific size (a pillow insert, a table).

Stitch Multiples

Many patterns require a foundation chain that is a multiple of a certain number. For example, “Multiple of 4 + 3” means your starting chain must be divisible by 4, then add 3 extra chains (e.g., 23, 27, 31, 35). The extra chains usually account for the turning chain.

US vs. UK Terminology

Important

All patterns in this collection use US terminology. If you are used to UK terms, use this table to convert. Getting these mixed up will change the entire size and appearance of your project.

US TERM	US ABBR.	UK EQUIVALENT	UK ABBR.
Slip stitch	sl st	Slip stitch	ss
Single crochet	sc	Double crochet	dc
Half double crochet	hdc	Half treble crochet	htr
Double crochet	dc	Treble crochet	tr
Treble crochet	tr	Double treble crochet	dtr
Double treble crochet	dtr	Triple treble crochet	trtr
Gauge	—	Tension	—
Skip	sk	Miss	miss
Yarn over	yo	Yarn over hook	yoh

SECTION 3

Yarn Guide

Everything you need to know about choosing the right yarn for home decor projects.

The yarn you choose determines how your finished piece looks, feels, and holds up over time. For items that will be used and washed regularly, this choice is especially important.

Yarn Weight Categories

WEIGHT	CYC SYMBOL	STITCHES PER 4" (SC)	RECOMMENDED HOOK (MM)	RECOMMENDED HOOK (US)	COMMON USES
0 — Lace	0	32–42	1.5–2.25	6–B/1	Doilies, delicate table toppers
1 — Superfine	1	21–32	2.25–3.5	B/1–E/4	Fine table runners, lace edgings
2 — Fine	2	16–20	3.5–4.5	E/4–7	Lightweight placemats, curtain ties
3 — DK / Light	3	12–17	4.5–5.5	7–I/9	Cushion covers, light throws
4 — Worsted / Medium	4	11–14	5.5–6.5	I/9–K/10.5	Blankets, cushions, organizers, most home decor
5 — Bulky	5	8–11	6.5–9	K/10.5–M/13	Chunky blankets, basket organizers
6 — Super Bulky	6	6–9	9–16	M/13–Q	Arm-knit blankets, large baskets
7 — Jumbo	7	5 or fewer	16+	Q and larger	Giant floor poufs, thick rugs

Fiber Types for Home Decor

FIBER	PROS	CONS	BEST HOME DECOR USES
Cotton	Excellent stitch definition, machine washable, breathable, no pilling	Less elastic, can feel stiff at first, heavier	Coasters, placemats, table runners, kitchen items, dishcloths
Acrylic	Affordable, huge color range, machine washable, lightweight, allergy-friendly	Can pill with heavy use, less breathable, melts under heat	Blankets, cushion covers, decorative items that are handled less
Wool	Warm, naturally elastic, beautiful drape, felting option	Can shrink in hot water, may felt unintentionally, some people are allergic	Winter throws, felted baskets, cushion covers (with pillow insert protection)
Bamboo	Silky feel, beautiful drape, naturally antibacterial, eco-friendly	Splits easily on the hook, stretches with weight, slippery	Lightweight throws, decorative cushion covers
Cotton-Acrylic Blend	Combines stitch definition of cotton with softness of acrylic, easy care	More expensive than pure acrylic	Versatile — good for nearly all home decor projects
Polyester	Durable, holds shape well, quick-drying	Lacks natural feel, can be squeaky on hook	Outdoor cushions, items that need heavy washing

Best Choices for Home Decor

Everyday items (coasters, placemats, kitchen organizers): 100% cotton in worsted weight — it washes beautifully and lies flat.

Blankets & throws: acrylic or cotton-acrylic blend for easy care and softness.

Cushion covers: cotton-acrylic blend or DK-weight cotton for crisp stitch definition.

Decorative pieces (wall hangings, table toppers): any fiber — pick for look and drape, since these are handled less.

How Much Yarn to Buy

Yarn amounts vary by stitch pattern, hook size, and your tension. Use these guidelines as starting estimates:

PROJECT TYPE	APPROXIMATE YARDAGE (WORSTED WEIGHT)
Coaster (10 cm / 4" diameter)	15–25 yards
Placemat (30 × 45 cm / 12 × 18")	100–150 yards
Table runner (30 × 120 cm / 12 × 48")	250–400 yards

PROJECT TYPE	APPROXIMATE YARDAGE (WORSTED WEIGHT)
Cushion cover (45 × 45 cm / 18 × 18")	200–350 yards (front + back)
Baby blanket (75 × 100 cm / 30 × 40")	800–1,200 yards
Throw blanket (130 × 180 cm / 50 × 70")	2,000–3,000 yards
Small organizer basket	150–250 yards

Golden rule: always buy one extra skein. Running out mid-project and finding the same dye lot is often impossible. You can always return unused skeins with a receipt.

Yarn Substitution Rules

- **Match the weight category first.** A worsted-weight substitute should also be worsted weight.
- **Check yardage, not just weight.** Two skeins of the same weight can have very different yardage. Match the total yards the pattern calls for.
- **Swatch before committing.** Different fibers at the same weight can produce different gauges.
- **Consider care instructions.** Substituting wool for a cotton pattern means the item can no longer be machine washed in hot water.
- **Consider drape.** Cotton hangs differently than acrylic. For structured items (baskets, coasters), stay close to the original fiber type.

SECTION 4

Essential Tools

Beyond the hook: every tool you need for professional-quality home decor crochet.

You can start crocheting with just a hook and yarn, but the right tools make each project faster, neater, and more enjoyable.

Hook Types & Materials

MATERIAL	FEEL	BEST FOR	PRICE RANGE
Aluminum	Smooth, fast, cool to touch	General crocheting, acrylic and cotton yarn	\$
Bamboo / Wood	Warm, slight grip, lightweight	Slippery yarns (silk, bamboo), people who prefer a slower pace	\$\$
Plastic	Very lightweight, flexible	Large hooks (9 mm+), budget-friendly option	\$
Steel	Thin, very smooth, precise	Thread crochet, doilies, lace work (sizes 0.6–2.0 mm)	\$
Ergonomic (rubber grip)	Cushioned handle, reduced hand fatigue	Long sessions, people with arthritis or hand pain	\$\$–\$\$\$

Hook Size Chart

METRIC (MM)	US SIZE	UK / CANADIAN SIZE
2.0	—	14
2.25	B/1	13
2.5	—	12
2.75	C/2	11
3.0	—	10
3.25	D/3	10
3.5	E/4	9

Metric (mm)	US Size	UK / Canadian Size
3.75	F/5	9
4.0	G/6	8
4.5	7	7
5.0	H/8	6
5.5	I/9	5
6.0	J/10	4
6.5	K/10.5	3
7.0	—	2
8.0	L/11	0
9.0	M/13	00
10.0	N/15	000
12.0	P/16	—
15.0	P/Q	—
16.0	Q	—
19.0	S	—

Other Essential Tools

Tool	What It Does	Why You Need It
Tapestry Needles	Large-eye, blunt-tip needles for weaving in ends and seaming	Essential for finishing every project neatly
Stitch Markers	Small clips or rings that mark a specific stitch	Track the first stitch of a round, mark pattern repeats, count stitches
Measuring Tape	Flexible tape for measuring gauge swatches and finished pieces	Accuracy for items that need to fit (cushion covers, placemats)
Row Counter	Mechanical or digital counter you click after each row	Keeps track of rows in long projects like blankets

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	WHY YOU NEED IT
Sharp Scissors	Small, sharp scissors for cutting yarn cleanly	A clean cut makes weaving in ends much easier
Blocking Pins	Rust-proof T-pins or blocking pins	Hold your project in shape during blocking
Blocking Mats	Interlocking foam tiles with grid lines	Flat surface for pinning and drying blocked projects
Spray Bottle	Fine mist spray for wet and spray blocking	Even moisture distribution without soaking

Starter Toolkit Recommendation

If you are setting up your workspace for the first time, start with these:

- Set of aluminum hooks: 3.5 mm (E/4) through 6.5 mm (K/10.5)
- 10 locking stitch markers
- 2 tapestry needles (different sizes)
- Fabric measuring tape
- Small sharp scissors
- Row counter

Total investment: approximately \$15–\$25. Everything else is optional and can be added as your projects grow in complexity.

SECTION 5

Finishing Techniques

Turn a good project into a professional-looking piece with these essential finishing skills.

The difference between homemade and handmade is in the finishing. These techniques take minutes but transform the final result.

Blocking

Blocking is the process of shaping your finished crochet piece to its final dimensions using moisture and/or heat. It evens out stitches, opens up lace patterns, and makes edges lie flat.

METHOD	HOW	BEST FOR	DRY TIME
Wet Blocking	Soak the piece in lukewarm water for 15–20 minutes. Gently squeeze (never wring). Lay flat on blocking mats, pin to dimensions, let air dry completely.	Cotton items, lace, anything that needs significant reshaping	12–24 hours
Steam Blocking	Pin the piece to blocking mats. Hold a steam iron 2–3 cm above the fabric (never touch). Let the steam penetrate, then let it dry pinned.	Acrylic yarn (sets the shape permanently — called “killing” acrylic), wool	1–4 hours
Spray Blocking	Pin the piece to blocking mats. Mist evenly with water using a spray bottle. Let dry completely while pinned.	Items that need light shaping, quick touch-ups, delicate fibers	4–8 hours

Acrylic Warning

Never press a hot iron directly onto acrylic yarn. It will melt and flatten permanently. Steam only, with the iron hovering above the fabric.

Seaming Methods

METHOD	HOW	RESULT	BEST FOR
Whip Stitch	Hold pieces together, wrong sides facing. Thread tapestry needle. Pass through both pieces from back to front, repeat along the edge.	Visible seam, slightly raised ridge	Quick joins, cushion backs, granny squares
Mattress Stitch	Hold pieces side by side, right sides up. Sew through corresponding stitches on each piece in a zigzag pattern.	Nearly invisible seam	Cushion covers, blanket panels, anything visible on the right side

METHOD	HOW	RESULT	BEST FOR
Slip Stitch Join	Hold pieces together, insert hook through both layers, yarn over and pull through all loops. Repeat along edge.	Decorative ridge, fast	Granny squares, motif blankets, decorative seams
Single Crochet Join	Hold pieces together, sc through both layers along the edge.	Strong, visible ridge	Organizer baskets, items needing structural strength

Weaving in Ends

- Leave at least a 15 cm (6”) tail when fastening off — shorter tails work loose over time.
- Thread the tail onto a tapestry needle. Weave through 5–6 stitches along the back of the work, changing direction at least once (a zigzag path).
- For items that will be washed frequently (coasters, placemats), weave through 8–10 stitches and consider adding a tiny dot of fabric glue to the last stitch.
- Trim the excess close to the fabric, then stretch the fabric gently so the trimmed end slips back inside.

Adding Closures & Extras

ADDITION	HOW TO ATTACH	TIPS
Buttons	Sew on with matching thread through the crochet fabric. Reinforce with a small piece of felt behind the button on loose fabrics.	Make button loops with chain stitches during the border round. Test the fit before finishing.
Zippers	Pin the zipper in place first, then hand-sew with a backstitch using matching thread.	Use for cushion covers. A zipper makes removing the insert for washing easy.
Fabric Lining	Cut lining fabric 1 cm larger than the crochet piece on all sides. Fold edges under, pin, and hand-sew with a slip stitch.	Adds structure to bags and organizers. Prevents items from poking through openwork patterns.
Non-Slip Backing	Apply non-slip fabric or shelf liner to the back of coasters and placemats with fabric glue or hand-stitching.	Essential for coasters on polished surfaces. Test the glue on a swatch first.

Finishing Checklist

☐ All ends woven in securely (15 cm minimum, zigzag path)

☐ Piece blocked to final dimensions

☐ Seams closed neatly (right sides matching)

☐ Stitch count verified on final round/row

☐ Buttons, zippers, or closures tested for fit

☐ Lining or backing added (if applicable)

☐ Project photographed before gifting or displaying

SECTION 6

Troubleshooting

Common crochet problems, what causes them, and how to fix them every time.

Every crocheter has faced these issues. Knowing the cause is half the fix. This section will save you hours of frustration and frogging.

Uneven Edges

The Problem

Your sides look wavy, with stitches that jut out or dip in. The piece looks like it is growing or shrinking width-wise.

The Fix

Cause: Missing the first or last stitch of a row, or counting the turning chain incorrectly.

Solution: Place a stitch marker in the first stitch of every row. Count your stitches at the end of every row until the problem stops. Decide once whether your turning chain counts as a stitch and be consistent throughout the entire project.

Counting Errors

The Problem

Your stitch count keeps changing from row to row, and the piece is getting wider or narrower.

The Fix

Cause: Accidentally adding stitches (working into the wrong space) or skipping stitches.

Solution: Count after every row — compare your count to the pattern. Use stitch markers every 10 or 20 stitches on long rows. If you are consistently off by 1 at the end, check whether you are accidentally working into the turning chain or missing the last stitch.

Tension Issues

The Problem

Some stitches are tight and others are loose, creating an uneven fabric. Your gauge does not match the pattern.

The Fix

Cause: Inconsistent yarn tension, often caused by changing grip pressure during a session.

Solution: Practice maintaining even tension by crocheting a 15 cm swatch before starting each project. If your stitches tighten when you are tired, take breaks. Use an ergonomic hook if you tend to grip tightly. Some crocheters find that wrapping the yarn around their pinky finger an extra time evens out loose tension.

Curling Fabric

The Problem

Your single crochet fabric curls inward at the edges, forming a tube instead of lying flat.

The Fix

Cause: Single crochet is naturally dense and tends to curl, especially with tight tension.

Solution: Go up one hook size. Add a border of a taller stitch (half double crochet or double crochet). Block the finished piece aggressively. For items like coasters, blocking and a non-slip backing solve the problem entirely.

Puckering (Bunching Up)

The Problem

The fabric bunches and does not lie flat, especially in the center of circles or when changing stitches.

The Fix

Cause: Too many increases in round projects, or a hook that is too small for the yarn weight.

Solution: Follow the increase schedule exactly: for flat circles in sc, increase by 6 stitches per round (12 for dc). If you are following the pattern exactly and it still puckers, try going up half a hook size. Blocking can correct minor puckering.

Wavy Edges on Flat Pieces

The Problem

The edges of your flat rectangular piece ripple or wave instead of lying straight.

The Fix

Cause: Too many stitches for the width (accidental increases), or inconsistent turning chains.

Solution: Count stitches at the end of each row. Make sure you are not accidentally working into the base of the turning chain when it already counts as a stitch. If the waviness is in a finished piece, blocking will fix mild cases. Severe cases need frogging back to where the count went wrong.

Twisted Foundation Chain

The Problem

After working Row 1, you realize the foundation chain has twisted, and the fabric is not flat.

The Fix

Cause: The chain rotated during Row 1, or the chain was very long and hard to manage.

Solution: For long chains (50+ stitches), pin the chain flat to a blocking mat before starting Row 1. Check after every 10–15 stitches that the chain has not twisted. Alternatively, use a foundation single crochet (fsc) instead — it creates the chain and the first row simultaneously, eliminating the twist problem entirely.

Color Changes Showing Through

The Problem

When changing colors, you can see a dot of the old color bleeding into the new color row.

The Fix

Cause: The color change was made too late in the stitch.

Solution: Always switch to the new color on the last yarn-over of the previous stitch. For single crochet: insert hook, yarn over with old color and pull up a loop, yarn over with new color and pull through both loops. The top of the stitch will now be the new color, creating a clean line.

Next Step

You now have a complete reference for every stitch, material, and technique in this collection. Keep this guide beside you as you work through the 30 patterns — you will find yourself coming back to it again and again.

Open the main pattern book and pick your first project. Start with something small — a coaster or a placemat — to warm up, then work your way up to cushion covers and blankets.

Happy crocheting!